

Question:

A mental health volunteer is interviewing locals as part of a community outreach program. A 46-year-old man discloses that he has felt sad for as long as he can remember. He feels as though his life is cursed and if something terrible can happen to him, it usually will. He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless. He also feels that he has had worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, energy, and concentration over the past 2 weeks. He is otherwise getting enough sleep and able to hold a job. Which of the following statement best describes this patient's condition?

Answer Choices:

- A. The patient is at risk for double depression.
- B. The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis.
- C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
- D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.

Reasoning + Answer:

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** Finding reasoning paths : **

- 1 . Evaluate the duration of symptoms : The patient has felt sad for as long as he can remember , which suggests a chronic or lifelong mood disorder .
- 2 . Assess the current intensity of symptoms : The recent worsening of suicidal ide ations , guilt , energy , and concentration over the past two weeks suggests a recent acute exacerb ation of a pre -existing mood disorder .
- 3 . Consider the combination of symptoms : Chronic sadness , hope lessness , and acute exacerb ation of suicidal ide ations with some improvement in energy and concentration could indicate a depressive episode .
- 4 . Evaluate the impact on daily functioning : The patient is able to maintain employment , which suggests that the symptoms do not fully impair his ability to work , but may still cause significant distress .

** Reason ing Process : **

- 1 . ** Duration of Symptoms : ** The patient reports feeling sad for as long as he can remember , which is a strong indicator of a lifelong mood disorder such as major depressive disorder (MDD) or dyst h ym ic disorder . These conditions involve persistent sadness and feelings of hope lessness .
- 2 . ** Ac ute Ex acerba tion : ** The recent onset of worsening suicidal ide ations , along with a brief improvement in energy and concentration , suggests an acute depressive episode . This is consistent with a pattern seen in recurrent depressive disorders , where depressive episodes may alternate with periods of partial rem ission .
- 3 . ** Sym ptoms Analysis : ** The combination of chronic sadness , hope lessness , and acute suicidal ide ations is highly characteristic of a depressive episode . The improvement in energy and concentration is less common in full depressive episodes but can occur in situations with environmental improvement or a brief break from the baseline depression .
- 4 . ** Impact on Function ing : ** The patient’s ability to maintain employment indicates that the symptoms are not severely impairing his ability to work , though they may be causing significant distress . This suggests a depressive episode rather than a full psychotic disorder , where functioning would typically be more severely impaired .

** Conclusion : **

The patient’s presentation aligns with a pattern of chronic depression (possibly dyst h ym ic disorder) with recurrent acute depressive episodes . This is supported by the combination of long -standing sadness , recent suicidal ide ations , and acute improvements in energy and concentration , which are consistent with a depressive episode . The current symptoms suggest an acute exacerb ation of a pre-existing mood disorder .

</think>
< answer >
The patient is likely to show anhedonia .
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